Coaching Codex

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COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 14 · AI MEETING NOTES & PRODUCTIVITY

The AI-Powered Workday: Email, Docs & Planning

Plan your day in five minutes, draft emails and documents from your own facts, and review your week, using the AI tools you already have.

5 min
morning planning prompt, facts only

4
step drafting routine for email and docs

15 min
Friday review you check

START HERE

Busy all day, little done? Give AI three small jobs.

You do not need a new app or a big system. This guide puts AI into the tools you already use with three short habits: a 5-minute morning plan, a faster way to draft emails and documents from your own facts, and a 15-minute Friday review. You stay in charge of every decision; AI does the first draft.

Plan

5 min each morning

Turn your calendar and task list into a realistic plan for today.

Draft

Email & docs

Go from your bullet points to a checked first draft, in your voice.

Review

15 min on Friday

See what got done, what slipped and what to change next week.

What's inside

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YOUR FACTS IN, A DRAFT OUT

AI saves time when you give it the facts (your meetings, tasks, deadlines, notes) and ask it to organize or draft. It wastes time when you ask it to guess. Every prompt in this guide tells the AI to use only your facts and to ask when something is missing.

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SECTION 01 · THE BASICS

Where AI fits in your day (and where it doesn't)

Most lost time hides in small jobs: deciding what to do first, staring at a blank email, rewriting a document from scratch. These are exactly the jobs where an AI first draft helps.

Good job for AI	Keep for yourself
Turning a messy task list into an ordered plan	Deciding what truly matters this week
Drafting an email reply from your bullet points	Promises, prices and deadlines you give clients
Turning rough notes into a structured document	Final facts, figures and legal wording
Shortening, simplifying or fixing the tone of a draft	Sensitive conversations (HR, complaints, money)
Summarizing your week from your own notes	Judging your team's or your own performance

The one-line rule

AI organizes and drafts; you decide and send. Treat every answer like work from a helpful new assistant: useful, fast, and not final until you have checked it against your calendar, records or notes.

PROMPT · FIND YOUR BIGGEST TIME-WASTERS

Here is roughly how I spent yesterday: **[LIST WHAT YOU DID AND ABOUT HOW LONG EACH TOOK]**.
My role: **[YOUR ROLE AND TYPE OF BUSINESS]**.
Group these into: planning, email, documents, meetings, other. For each group, suggest one job an AI first draft could help with. Use only what I listed. Do not guess times I did not give. If something is unclear, ask me first.

EXERCISE 1 · YOUR THREE SLOWEST JOBS (3 MINUTES)

Write down the three everyday jobs that eat the most time for you (for example: answering the same questions by email, writing proposals, planning the week).

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SECTION 02 · SETUP

Set up: use the AI you already have

Start with what is already on your computer or phone. Many email and office tools now include an AI assistant, depending on your plan and settings. Features change often, so check what your current tools include before you pay for anything new.

Option	How it works	Good when	Check first
AI inside your office tools	Assistants built into Microsoft 365 (Copilot) or Google Workspace (Gemini) work in your email and documents	You already pay for one of these suites	Whether your plan and admin settings include it
A chat assistant	You copy facts into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot and paste the draft back	You want one place for every job	Remove client names and sensitive details first
A saved assistant	A custom GPT, Gem or Project that remembers your tone and rules	You repeat the same jobs every day	Store only facts you are happy to share

PROMPT · SAVE YOUR WORKING PROFILE

Remember these facts for drafting my work today:
My role: **[ROLE]**. Business: **[TYPE OF BUSINESS AND LOCATION]**.
My usual tone: **[TONE, E.G. FRIENDLY AND DIRECT]**.
My working hours: **[HOURS]**. Writing rules: **[E.G. US SPELLING, SHORT PARAGRAPHS]**.
Use only these facts. If you need anything else for a task, ask me instead of guessing. Reply with a one-line confirmation only.

KEEP PRIVATE THINGS PRIVATE

Before you paste anything into an AI tool, remove passwords, bank details, health information and personal data you do not need. If you have UK or EU clients, emails and documents can contain personal data covered by GDPR. Follow your company's rules on which AI tools you may use for work.

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SECTION 03 · MORNING

Morning: the 5-minute planning prompt

Before you open your inbox, give AI your fixed meetings, your task list with rough time estimates, and today's deadlines. Ask for a realistic plan, not a perfect one.

1. Copy today's meetings from your calendar (time and type only, no client names).
2. List your tasks with a rough time estimate and any real deadline.
3. Say when you focus best (for example the first two hours of the day).
4. Run the prompt below and check the plan against your calendar.
5. Block the focus times in your calendar so others can see them.

PROMPT · PLAN MY DAY

Plan my working day from **[START TIME]** to **[END TIME]**.
Fixed meetings (do not move): **[PASTE MEETINGS WITH TIMES]**
Tasks with time estimates and deadlines: **[PASTE TASKS]**
I focus best: **[WHEN]**
Put tasks due today first, use my focus time for the hardest task, and leave a short buffer before meetings. Use only these meetings and tasks. Do not invent tasks or change my estimates. If something does not fit, list it under "Doesn't fit today" instead of squeezing it in. If a deadline or estimate is missing, ask me first.

PLANS FAIL ON ESTIMATES, NOT ON AI

If the plan looks too full, it probably is. Cut or move a task yourself rather than asking AI to make everything fit. A plan with open time in it is more likely to survive the day.

EXERCISE 2 · TOMORROW'S INPUTS

Write tomorrow's fixed meetings and your top four tasks with a time estimate each. That is all the morning prompt needs.

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SECTION 04 · EMAIL

Midday: email faster without losing your voice

Batch your email into one or two blocks a day. For each reply, write three bullet points of what you want to say, then let AI turn them into a short, clear email.

PROMPT · REPLY FROM MY BULLET POINTS

Draft a reply to this email:
[PASTE EMAIL, NAMES AND PRIVATE DETAILS REMOVED]
What I want to say: **[YOUR 2–4 BULLET POINTS]**
Tone: **[TONE]**. Language: **[LANGUAGE]**. Under **[NUMBER]** words.
Use only my bullet points and the facts in the email. Do not add promises, prices, dates or apologies I did not give. If my bullets do not answer the sender's question, tell me what is missing instead of guessing.

PROMPT · CLEAR MY INBOX BACKLOG

Here are the subject lines and first lines of **[NUMBER]** unread emails:
[PASTE LIST]
Sort them into: reply today, reply this week, file or delete, delegate to **[ROLE]**. Give a one-line reason for each. Do not draft any replies yet. If you cannot tell what an email needs, put it under "Ask me".

Common email	What to give AI	Watch for
Yes / no / not yet	Your decision and one reason	Softened into a vague maybe
Scheduling	Your real free times	Made-up times or time zones
Status update	What is done, what is next, real dates	Optimistic dates you did not give

YOU PRESS SEND

Never let a draft go out unread. Check names, dates and amounts against your records, and keep anything sensitive (complaints, money, HR) fully in your own words.

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SECTION 05 · DOCUMENTS

Docs: a drafting routine from notes to final

Proposals, procedures, reports and updates all follow the same four steps. Doing them in order is faster than asking for a finished document in one go.

1 · OUTLINE
AI suggests headings from your notes

2 · DRAFT
One section at a time, from your facts

3 · CHECK
Facts, figures and names against records

4 · POLISH
Shorten, simplify, fix tone

PROMPT · OUTLINE FROM MY NOTES

I need to write a **[DOCUMENT TYPE]** for **[READER]**.
Its purpose: **[WHAT THE READER SHOULD KNOW OR DO]**.
My rough notes: **[PASTE NOTES]**
Suggest an outline with 4–6 headings and, under each, which of my notes belong there. Use only my notes. List any heading where I have no facts yet under "Missing information".

PROMPT · DRAFT ONE SECTION

Using this outline: **[PASTE OUTLINE]**
Draft only the section "**[HEADING]**" from these facts: **[FACTS FOR THIS SECTION]**.
Reader: **[READER]**. Tone: **[TONE]**. Under **[NUMBER]** words.
Use only these facts. Do not invent figures, prices, dates, names or quotes. Where a fact is missing, write [TO CONFIRM] instead of guessing.

EXERCISE 3 · YOUR NEXT DOCUMENT

Pick one document you need to write this week. Who is the reader, and what should they know or do after reading it?

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SECTION 06 · VERIFY

Check every draft before it leaves your desk

A smooth draft can still be wrong. Spend two minutes on every plan, email and document before you rely on it, and check against the source, not against the AI's own opinion.

- [ ] Meetings, dates and deadlines match your calendar and records
- [ ] Every fact, figure and name comes from your notes, not from the AI
- [ ] No new promises, prices, discounts or apologies were added
- [ ] [TO CONFIRM] gaps are filled with confirmed facts or removed
- [ ] Tone and length suit the reader, and private details are removed

PROMPT · FIND WHAT I DIDN'T GIVE YOU

Here are the facts I gave you:
[PASTE YOUR FACTS OR NOTES]
Here is your draft:
[PASTE DRAFT]
List every date, number, name, promise and claim in the draft. Mark each FROM MY FACTS or NOT IN MY FACTS. Then rewrite the draft removing everything marked NOT IN MY FACTS. Do not add anything new.

Check	Pass?	Note
Dates and times match my calendar		
Facts and figures match my records		
No new promises added		
Private details removed		

REPAIR PHRASE THAT WORKS

When a draft invents or changes something, reply: **Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.** The check prompt helps you spot problems, but the final check is you comparing the draft with your calendar, records and notes.

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SECTION 07 · WEEKLY REVIEW

Friday: the 15-minute weekly review

Once a week, look back before you plan ahead. Paste in what you planned and what actually happened, and let AI help you spot patterns. You decide what changes.

1. **Collect** (5 min): this week's planned tasks, what got done, and what slipped.
2. **Review** (5 min): run the prompt below and read the patterns it finds.
3. **Decide** (3 min): choose up to three priorities for next week yourself.
4. **Block** (2 min): put focus time for those priorities in next week's calendar.

PROMPT · WEEKLY REVIEW

This week I planned: **[PLANNED TASKS]**.
What got done: **[DONE]**. What slipped and why: **[SLIPPED, WITH REASONS IF KNOWN]**.
Next week's fixed commitments: **[MEETINGS AND DEADLINES]**.
Summarize the week in 5 bullets, list any pattern in what slipped, and suggest up to 3 priorities for next week with a reason for each. Use only what I listed. Do not judge my performance or invent reasons. If something is unclear, ask me first.

- One saved morning prompt
- Email in one or two blocks a day
- One document drafted section by section
- A 15-minute review every Friday

YOU SET THE PRIORITIES

AI can point out patterns in what you gave it, but it does not know your clients, your goals or your energy. Treat its priority list as suggestions and pick next week's three yourself.

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SECTION 08 · HABIT

Your 7-day starter plan and tracker

Use the first week to try each habit once, then keep the ones that saved you time.

Day	Action	Time (est.)	Done
1	Write down your 3 slowest jobs; check which AI tools you already have	15 min	
2	Save your working profile; run the morning planning prompt	10 min	
3	Plan again; batch email into one block with the reply prompt	20 min	
4	Outline one document from your notes	15 min	
5	Draft that document section by section; run the check prompt	30 min	
6	Run your first weekly review; pick 3 priorities for next week	15 min	
7	Save the prompts that worked; block next week's focus time	10 min	

Times are rough estimates and vary by role and workload.

PROMPT · IMPROVE MY ROUTINE

This week I used AI for: [JOBS].
What saved time: [WINS]. What went wrong: [PROBLEMS, E.G. PLANS TOO FULL, INVENTED DATES].
Rewrite my morning planning prompt so it avoids these problems next time, and list 3 checks I must never skip. Do not invent anything about my work.

Safety checklist

- [ ] Every plan matched my real calendar and deadlines
- [ ] Every email and document was checked against my facts before sending
- [ ] Private and sensitive details stayed out of AI tools

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FIRST WIN · FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

Your first win, start to finish

Walk through one morning plan for a made-up one-person bookkeeping practice in Denver, Colorado. Nothing here is a real business, real people or live AI output.

Example input	Value
Business	Cedar Lane Bookkeeping (fictional), Denver, Colorado; one owner
Working hours	8:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.; best focus in the morning
Fixed meetings	9:00–9:30 client call (bakery client) · 12:00–1:00 lunch · 3:00–3:30 team check-in
Tasks	Send March invoices to 4 clients, 30 min, due today · Draft engagement letter for a new client, 90 min, due Thursday · Reply to 6 flagged emails, 45 min · Update the client onboarding checklist, 60 min

EXAMPLE COMPLETED PROMPT

Plan my working day from 8:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. (fictional example for practice).

Fixed meetings (do not move): 9:00–9:30 client call (bakery client); 12:00–1:00 lunch; 3:00–3:30 team check-in
Tasks with time estimates and deadlines:
Send March invoices to 4 clients · 30 min · due today
Draft engagement letter for a new client · 90 min · due Thursday
Reply to 6 emails flagged yesterday · 45 min · no deadline
Update the client onboarding checklist · 60 min · no deadline
I focus best in the morning.

Put tasks due today first, use my focus time for the hardest task, and keep meetings at their times. Use only these meetings and tasks. Do not invent tasks or change my estimates. If something does not fit, list it under "Doesn't fit today". If a deadline or estimate is missing, ask me before answering.

Copy it, open your AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot), paste and send. Then compare what you get with this:

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

8:30–9:00 Send March invoices to 4 clients (due today)
9:00–9:30 Client call (bakery client)
9:30–11:00 Draft engagement letter (due Thursday), focus block
11:00–11:45 Reply to 6 flagged emails
12:00–1:00 Lunch
1:00–2:00 Update the client onboarding checklist
3:00–3:30 Team check-in
Open time: 11:45–12:00, 2:00–3:00, 3:30–5:00 · Doesn't fit today: nothing

Checks before use

- [ ] All three meetings stay at their original times: 9:00, 12:00 and 3:00.
- [ ] The invoices, the only task due today, come first at 8:30.
- [ ] Each task block matches its estimate: 30, 90, 45 and 60 minutes.
- [ ] Nothing was added: no new tasks, meetings or deadlines.

USE IT

Copy the checked plan into your calendar or task app yourself and block the focus time. The webpage does not change your calendar.

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GUIDED TASK

Plan today in 5 minutes

When to use it: First thing in the morning, before you open your inbox. **Prepare:** Today's fixed meetings with times (no client names); Your tasks with a rough time estimate each; Any real deadlines.

Question	Example answer
What are your working hours today?	8:30 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.
Paste today's fixed meetings with times.	9:00–9:30 client call (bakery client) · 12:00–1:00 lunch · 3:00–3:30 team check-in
List your tasks with a time estimate and any deadline.	Send March invoices to 4 clients · 30 min · due today · Draft engagement letter for a new client · 90 min · due Thursday · Reply to 6 emails flagged yesterday · 45 min · no deadline · Update the client onboarding checklist · 60 min · no deadline
When do you focus best?	In the morning
Describe your business in one sentence.	A one-person bookkeeping practice in Denver, Colorado
Which language should the result be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

About me: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Plan my working day: [WORKING HOURS].
Fixed meetings (do not move):
[MEETINGS]
Tasks with time estimates and deadlines:
[TASKS]
I focus best: [FOCUS TIME]. Language: [LANGUAGE].

Put tasks due today first, use my focus time for the hardest task, and keep meetings at their times. Use only these meetings and tasks. Do not invent tasks or change my estimates. If something does not fit, list it under "Doesn't fit today" instead of squeezing it in. If a deadline or estimate is missing, ask me before planning.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

8:30–9:00 Send March invoices (due today) · 9:00–9:30 Client call · 9:30–11:00 Engagement letter (focus) · 11:00–11:45 Flagged emails · 12:00–1:00 Lunch · 1:00–2:00 Onboarding checklist · 3:00–3:30 Team check-in · Open: 2:00–3:00, 3:30–5:00 · Doesn't fit today: nothing.

Checks before use

- [ ] Every meeting is at the same time as in your calendar.
- [ ] Tasks due today come first.
- [ ] Each block matches your own time estimate.
- [ ] No new tasks, meetings or deadlines were added.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Invented or changed a fact	“Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.”
Moved a fixed meeting	“Put “[MEETING]” back at [TIME]. It cannot move. Re-plan around it and change nothing else.”
Plan is too full	“Move “[TASK]” to Doesn't fit today and leave that time open. Change nothing else.”

Next action: Block the focus times in your calendar, then batch your email with the draft task below.

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GUIDED TASK

Draft an email or document section from your notes

When to use it: You know what you want to say but do not want to start from a blank page. **Prepare:** Your bullet points or rough notes; Who will read it and what they should do; Names and private details removed.

Question	Example answer
What are you writing?	An email reply to a client asking when their tax documents are due
Who will read it, and what should they do afterwards?	A small-business client; they should send their documents by the deadline
Paste your facts or bullet points.	Documents needed by March 20 · Send via our secure upload link (already in their welcome email) · I'll confirm receipt within 2 working days
What tone should it have?	Friendly and clear
Maximum length, in words?	100
Which language should the result be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Draft [WHAT YOU ARE WRITING].
Reader and goal: [READER AND GOAL]
My facts:
[YOUR FACTS]
Tone: [TONE]. Language: [LANGUAGE]. Under [NUMBER] words.

Use only my facts. Do not invent dates, prices, names, promises or apologies. Where a fact is missing, write [TO CONFIRM] instead of guessing. If my facts do not cover what the reader needs, tell me what is missing before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Hi, thanks for checking. Please send your documents by March 20 using the secure upload link in your welcome email. I'll confirm I've received them within 2 working days. Thanks!

Checks before use

- [ ] Every date and promise comes from your facts (here: March 20, 2 working days).
- [ ] No new promises, prices or apologies were added.
- [ ] [TO CONFIRM] gaps are filled with confirmed facts or removed.
- [ ] A human read it before sending, and private details are out.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Invented or changed a fact	"Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else."
Added a promise you did not make	"Remove "[PROMISE]". I did not offer that. Change nothing else."
Too long or too formal	"Rewrite in under [NUMBER] words in a [WARMER / MORE DIRECT] tone. Keep every fact exactly as written."

Next action: Paste the checked draft into your email or document yourself and send it from your own account.

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GUIDED TASK

Run your 15-minute Friday review

When to use it: At the end of the week, before you plan the next one. **Prepare:** What you planned this week; What got done and what slipped; Next week's fixed meetings and deadlines.

Question	Example answer
What did you plan to do this week?	Send March invoices; finish engagement letter; update onboarding checklist; reply to all flagged emails
What got done?	Invoices sent; engagement letter sent; flagged emails answered
What slipped, and why (if you know)?	Onboarding checklist: afternoon blocks taken by unplanned client calls
Next week's fixed meetings and deadlines.	Quarterly filing deadline Wednesday; two client calls Tuesday
Which language should the result be in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

This week I planned:
[PLANNED TASKS]
What got done:
[DONE]
What slipped and why:
[SLIPPED]
Next week's fixed commitments:
[NEXT WEEK'S COMMITMENTS]
Language: [LANGUAGE].

Summarize the week in 5 bullets, list any pattern in what slipped, and suggest up to 3 priorities for next week with a reason for each. Use only what I listed. Do not judge my performance or invent reasons. If something is unclear, ask me before answering.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Week: 3 of 4 planned tasks done (invoices, engagement letter, flagged emails). Slipped: onboarding checklist. Pattern: afternoon blocks were lost to unplanned client calls. Suggested priorities: 1) Quarterly filing before Wednesday's deadline. 2) Onboarding checklist in a morning focus block. 3) Keep one afternoon slot open for unplanned calls.

Checks before use

- [ ] The done and slipped lists match what you entered.
- [ ] Reasons come only from what you wrote, not from guesses.
- [ ] Suggested priorities fit next week's real deadlines.
- [ ] You chose the final three priorities yourself.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Invented or changed a fact	"Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else."
Invented a reason	"Remove the reason given for "[TASK]". I did not say why. Change nothing else."
Too many priorities	"Keep only these priorities: [YOUR 3]. Change nothing else."

Next action: Put focus time for your three priorities into next week's calendar yourself.

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WHAT'S NEXT

Plan in five minutes. Draft from your facts. Review every Friday.

A realistic morning plan, emails and documents drafted from your own notes, and a weekly look back: that is an AI-powered workday you stay in charge of.

Automate Your Inbox and Customer Replies with AI

Go further with reply templates and inbox routines.

Never Take Meeting Notes Again: AI Notetakers & Summaries

Turn meetings into checked summaries and action items.

Custom AI Assistants for Your Business: Build Your First GPT, Gem or Project

Save your planning and drafting prompts as one reusable assistant.

50 Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Small Business Owners

Fifty ready prompts for marketing, sales, service, admin and planning.

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